ELYSIUM OSHC



EMPLOYEE POLICIES MANUAL

Issued 4th January, 2019

Our Service

Welcome to Elysium OSHC!

This handbook is designed to help new, current, and prospective employees understand who we are and what our expectations are for our employees. Each section addresses different aspects of Elysium OSHC and your employment.

Being able to understand who we are and meeting our expectations helps you to embody our commitment to high quality child care and represent the Service in a positive way. Thus, all employees are expected to read this handbook and agree to follow the policies herein.

As with any policy manual, this handbook is subject to amendment as policies change or are added. Information on revisions and changes will be available to employees as soon as possible after adoption, either in hardcopy supplements or online at Elysium OSHC's website at www.elysiumoshc.com.au.

Who We Are

Elysium OSHC began in 2011 at Seaford Primary School and was run by the program owner, Matthew Hine. In the early stages of the program only an After School Care service was on offer, which eventually became Before School, After School and Vacation Care.

The service operated on it's own over the next 5 years as it grew, taking in more and more children. In late 2017, Matthew decided to expand the business and began a steady path to opening more services in much needed areas of Victoria. It is expected that over the next 5 years the business will grow to 10+ services before expanding into other related fields of education, care and children's entertainment.

Mission Statement

Elysium OSHC's mission is to provide affordable care to diverse families within the community, with particular emphasis on supporting low income families and vulnerable communities. We provide a wide range of age-appropriate learning opportunities for children from 5 years to 13 years of age to develop and grow intellectually, socially, and emotionally, while also learning the physical skills necessary for day-to-day life.

Philosophy

(Insert your service philosophy)

Goals

The following are the basic goals for the children who are in our care:

Emotional:
 to become independent and learn to be in control of their emotions
 to be able to express and deal with the emotions they have
 to learn how others express and deal with emotions
 to develop empathy with others

Social:
 to be able to interact effectively with others, regardless of perceived differences
 to be able to respect others and the property of others
 to be able to function well in a group setting
 to be able to understand why they should cooperate with others
 to be able to develop meaningful friendships

Physical:
 to develop large and small motor skills
 to learn the importance of good nutrition and good hygiene
 to develop lifelong, healthy habits

Intellectual:
 to develop a lifetime love of learning
 to learn observation and discussion skills
 to build a love for reading
 to build upon natural curiosity
 to develop the foundation needed to advance in the primary grades

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I. PERSONNEL POLICIES

Elysium OSHC strives to employ people who are the best qualified to meet the needs of the Service and the children under our care. Employment shall be on the basis of proven competence or potential ability as indicated by academic achievements, personal attitude, and prior work experience in accordance with the necessary qualifications and essential duties listed on the job description.

The employment of all persons shall be contingent upon the approval of the Approved Provider.

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY EMPLOYER/NON-DISCRIMINATION POLICY

Elysium OSHC is an Equal Opportunity Employer. All employment activities will be conducted in a manner to assure equal opportunity for all and will be based solely on the individual merit and fitness of applicants, candidates, and/or employees without regard to race, color, religion, creed, sex, gender, age, national origin, sexual orientation, pregnancy, or disability.

Employees hired for positions where the primary responsibility is direct child care must be eighteen (18) years of age.

These requirements are in accordance with the regulations established by our Regulatory Authority and the Government of Australia.

EMPLOYMENT AT THE SERVICE

Once an applicant has been offered a position at Elysium OSHC, there are a number of additional criteria which must be met by the applicant within a prescribed time period in order to be employed at the Service. These include Working With Children Checks, First Aid Certificates and the completion of other documentation, which must be submitted and completed during the application process or within a pre-determined span of time upon being hired.

Elysium OSHC is committed to providing a healthy and safe environment for its employees, the children under our care, and for those who visit our facility. The following health and safety checks must be completed prior to employment:

 Criminal Background Check
This is to be completed through processing the Working With Children's Check (card). The Approved Provider will check the status regularly throughout employment. On commencement, the employee must register Elysium OSHC as a workplace and approve updates to be sent to the employer.

Required Training
Elysium OSHC must ensure that all staff have adequate and appropriate training to work with children. The following items are required training for all new employees of the Service:

 First aid HLTAID004 (within the first 30 days, CPR must be maintained from there on)
 Special Needs (including Inclusion Policy and general training)
 Child Protection Training
 Working With Difficult Children

Each type of training is described either in other sections of this handbook or information will be provided in separate documents to the employee at the training session. The financial responsibility for training is the responsibility of the employee unless explicitly made clear by the Approved Provider.

Other Required Documentation

Federal and state law require that Elysium OSHC have other documentation on file or recorded to ensure that you are eligible to work within this field in Australia.

 Education transcripts

Please note that the above list is not all-inclusive of items which may be required for a new hire to begin work at the Service. The orientation process will require additional documentation, and this will be explained before or during that time.

EMPLOYEE CLASSIFICATIONS

Every employee, at the time of hire, will be classified as PART-TIME.

New hires are considered PROVISIONAL employees for the first 3 months of their employment.

Provisional Status

All employees will be considered provisional for up to 90 calendar days of employment when initially hired or placed in a new position. During the Provisional Period, Elysium OSHC will evaluate the provisional employee's performance to determine if he or she meets the standards set by EOSHC as outlined by both the job description and this handbook.

Provisional employees who have been placed in a new position at the Service are not eligible to use any form of accrued paid absence during the provisional period (paid sick leave, vacation time, personal time), excluding designated holidays. The provisional period may be extended up to 30 days, by approval of the Approved Provider and only where it is deemed necessary and appropriate. In all cases of requests to extend an employee's provisional period, the Approved Provider will provide a performance appraisal and the reason for extension, and the length of extension that is recommended. Requests for extension cannot be submitted after the provisional period concludes.

Upon successful completion of the provisional period, the Approved Provider will recommend whether the provisional employee should be retained. The recommendation will be accompanied by a completed final provisional performance appraisal. Upon approval, the employee will enter regular employment status.

Should the provisional employee not be recommended for regular status, the employee will be terminated no later than the last day of the provisional period or any extension thereof.

Employment may be terminated at any time during the provisional period with or without cause.

Job Descriptions

Elysium OSHC currently has three primary positions, aside from the Approved Provider, with particular duties and responsibilities assigned to each.

Employees will receive copies of, and will be expected to be familiar with, their individual job descriptions. Please note that the responsibilities assigned to each position are not all-inclusive, and other duties appropriate to the position may be required. Full job descriptions are included in the Appendix of this handbook.

Pay Schedule/Recording Hours
Our work week begins on Monday at 6:00am and ends on Friday at 7pm.

Employees will be paid Fortnightly on Thursdays, and will fall into the regular payment cycle. Ask the Approved Provider when that will be.

Employees are responsible for recording their actual work times using the approved document. If employees fail to include hours or fail to provide reasons for additional hours, payment for this work cannot be included in the cycle until the Pay Clerk is aware of the reasoning. Employees who falsely represent the number of hours worked or those who fail to clock in and out correctly may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Evaluation and Advancement

Reviews of an employee's work are important to help determine advancement at the Service and an employee's suitability for continued employment. Provisional employees are evaluated at the 30 and 90-day mark; employees who successfully complete the provisional employment period are then evaluated annually thereafter, on or near the anniversary of the first day of employment. The impact of successful evaluations will be discussed at a scheduled meeting between the employee and the Approved Provider.

The purpose of each evaluation is to determine an employee's overall fitness for the job, the assigned duties, and the Service as a whole. They are intended to be a positive experience for the employee and the Approved Provider. Each evaluation will assess the entire period of employment since the employee's previous appraisal.

The first evaluation (at 30 days) helps to determine a new employee's overall competence and fitness for the job, as well as how the employee fits with the Service and its goals. Subsequent evaluations take into account overall job performance, in accordance with the employee's job description and other appropriate criteria as determined by the Approved Provider (such as goals) and conveyed to the employee.

Evaluations not only look back on an employee's performance, but also look forward by establishing short-term and long-term goals for the employee. Goals should serve both the needs of the Service and the employee, allowing both to grow. Progress toward reaching those goals may be used in an employee's annual evaluation. During the evaluation, the Approved Provider will go over the evaluation with the employee, discussing the employee's accomplishments, progress, and any areas of concern. The employee will be expected to sign the evaluation to indicate discussion and receipt of a copy of the evaluation. Note that signing the evaluation does not mean that the employee agrees with every item listed or discussed; in the case of an employee's disagreement with the appraisal, written comments from the employee may be attached to document the employee's objections to particular items (or the evaluation as a whole), as well as provide the employee's rebuttal to specific items.

All employees will receive a copy of their annual evaluations. The original, signed evaluation will be placed in the employee's personnel record. Materials related to the evaluation process may be obtained from the Approved Provider upon request.

Work Schedule

Work schedules are prepared by the Pay Clerk each week and will be posted on Wednesday, the week before the roster commences.

In the event that a parent is late in picking up a child (after 6pm), the employee must remain with the child until an approved adult arrives to take the child home. Employees will be paid for any such time beyond their normal work hours.

Hours of attendance have been carefully planned and employees are required to work the hours and days for which they have been scheduled. If you are unable to report to work for any reason, you must notify the Approved Provider at least 6 hours prior to your scheduled starting time. Failure to provide notice in a

timely manner will be considered unexcused absence and may result in disciplinary action. Employees will not be permitted to use available leave time for an unexcused absence. Employees who fail to notify the Approved Provider at all may be considered to have abandoned their position, which will result in termination.

Holidays and Other Closings

From time to time, the Service may be closed for a holiday observance, zero attendances or because of an emergency situation. Employees are not paid for their regularly scheduled hours during zero attendances or emergency closings. In situations where the Service closes after opening for the day, employees will be paid only for the hours they actually work.

Emergency Closings

Due to severe weather conditions or other emergency situations, there may be times when Elysium OSHC may be closed. Emergency closing is at the discretion of the Approved Provider.

HEALTH

Your health is important to us! Not only does your health affect your own ability to perform your duties effectively, but your health can also affect others - the children under your care, parents, and other staff. As such, staff should follow similar guidelines to those laid out for sending children home (temperature exceeding 38°C, vomiting, etc.) as indicators as to when staff should also remain at home instead of reporting to work, or when a staff member should be sent home from work.

Illness

If you are ill, please contact the Approved Provider at least 6 hours in advance to ensure that we are able to provide adequate coverage to meet State ratio requirements. In general, staff who provide adequate notice will not be required to provide documentation (doctor's note, etc.) for the first day of absence. Providing less than 6 hours' notice or having an illness which lasts more than a day may require official documentation in order to validate the absence and permit the employee to return to work.

Sick Leave

Please refer to your employment contract for an explanation of how earned sick leave may be used.

Other Types of Leave

Employee's work schedules have been established giving consideration to the student/teacher ratio, workloads, and coverage requirements. Employee absences have a detrimental effect on these conditions. While absence for illness and emergency situations may happen from time to time, employees will not be granted leave beyond their accrued vacation, sick, and personal leave as a standard practice.

In addition, other situations may occur where an employee needs to request time off from work. Some of these are described below. Requests for leave other than those detailed shall be referred to the Approved Provider, who may grant or withhold approval of such leave. All such absences shall generally be considered without pay or other compensation for the employee.

Please submit requests in advance for approval, whenever possible. Emergency circumstances will be considered on a case-by-case basis. Leave without pay will only be granted in extenuating circumstances. Leave without pay must be approved in advance of the requested start date of the leave by the Approved Provider. Requests must be submitted in writing.

Employees will receive written notice of the approval/denial for a requested leave of absence.

Leave without pay which has not been approved by the Approved Provider will be considered a voluntary termination.

SAFETY

The safety of our employees, the children under our care, and of anyone we may interact with is important to us as well. The following are general principles and guidelines; specific procedures are covered in the General Duties section of this handbook.

Hazards

During the course of your employment, you have the potential to be exposed to bodily fluids, blood-borne pathogens, and chemicals. Please review the appropriate policies in the General Duties section for more information on how to correctly deal with situations where these hazards might be present.

Accidents

Accidents and injuries on the job, while rare, can happen. In order to protect your claim for compensation and/or minimize liability for Elysium OSHC and its employees, all injuries or accidents to an employee occurring during the employee's scheduled hours at the service, no matter how minor, must be reported to the Approved Provider immediately.

All employees are covered by Workers' Compensation insurance and must seek treatment for accidents and injuries as required by the plan. Employees will be required to provide information regarding the accident or injury to the Approved Provider within one day of accident.

Employees who are placed on Workers' Compensation will be notified in writing of the status of the position, status of health insurance benefits, and their responsibilities while on Workers' Compensation.

Accidents involving children, parents, or visitors to the Service are covered in the General Duties section of this handbook.

Controlled Substances

To ensure the health and safety of the children at the Service and of other employees, there are other restrictions regarding both legal and illegal behaviours which have been shown to be detrimental to the employee and those around the employee.

All facilities, grounds, and vehicles of Elysium OSHC are tobacco-free environments. Smoking or any other use of a tobacco product in the presence of children or parents during working hours is strictly prohibited. Failure to abide by this policy will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Furthermore, using, possessing, or being under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs during working hours or while on Elysium OSHC property (including vehicles and during excursions) is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate termination of duties.

Weapons and other Safety Hazards

Possession or use of any type of weapon, dangerous object, or explosive device while on Service property is prohibited and will result in immediate termination. This does not include items which might reasonably be expected to be used during the normal course of an employee's duties.

TRAINING

Required Training and Education
It is the responsibility of all staff members to make sure their training and qualifications are current and that they also meet the requirements set out by the Department of Education. This includes, but is not limited to, First Aid, Tertiary Certificates and Diplomas, Working With Children's Check and Mandatory Reporting.

From time to time, Elysium OSHC will provide staff with training modules, courses and other professional development opportunities. This may be offered free of charge or at a cost to the employee, which will be discussed before commencement.

Staff members are required to attend training set out by the Approved Provider. If staff members are unable to complete the training, staff members may be subject to termination.

Career Development

Staff members are encouraged to pursue additional education opportunities which may benefit themselves and the Service. Where an opportunity exists to advance in the organisation, all staff members will be notified and are welcome to apply.

OTHER POLICIES

Meals and Breaks

Because of ratio requirements and state guidelines, meals and breaks at the Service are handled as follows: Employees are able to bring their own food and drinks to the Service. These items must reflect good role modelling and not contain items that may cause an allergic reaction to the children and other staff. Staff members are to use good judgement when deciding the right time to have their meals.

For a dual staff model, employees may take a break of up to 15 minutes for every full 3 hours worked, ratios and staffing requirements permitting. Breaks of this sort are considered unpaid time. Employees cannot leave children unattended during a break, and ratios must be maintained at all times.

Required Staff Meetings

Because communication between the staff and the Approved Provider is crucial to good practices within the Service, mandatory staff meetings will be scheduled on a monthly basis, depending on he requirement. All employees are expected to attend these meetings if asked by the Approved Provider; exceptions must be approved in writing by the Approved Provider, in advance of the meeting. All staff meetings will be announced in advance and generally will occur outside the Service hours. Employees may be compensated at their normal hourly pay rate for the meeting.

CONDUCT AND ETHICS

The reputation of Elysium OSHC is built upon the ethical conduct of our employees, and the overall success of the business is tied to this as well. Our reputation for integrity and excellence requires careful observance of the spirit and letter of applicable laws and regulations, as well as a scrupulous regard for the highest professional standards of conduct and personal integrity.

Elysium OSHC is dependent upon our families' trust and we are dedicated to preserving that trust. Employees have a duty to Elysium OSHC and its families to act in a way that will merit the continued trust and confidence of the public.

Elysium OSHC will comply with all applicable laws and regulations and expects its directors and employees to conduct business in accordance with the letter, spirit, and intent of all relevant laws, statutes, ordinances, and regulations and to refrain from any illegal, dishonest, or unethical conduct.

In general, the use of good judgment, based on high ethical principles, will guide employees with respect to acceptable conduct. When a situation arises where it is difficult to determine the proper course of action, the employee should discuss the matter with the Approved Provider.

Compliance with these principles of conduct and ethics is the responsibility of every Elysium OSHC employee. Disregarding or failing to meet any of the following standards may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Personal Appearance

All employees are expected to present a neat and clean appearance and to dress appropriately for their position and duties. An employee's appearance and dress should reflect the professional nature of the position as well as be functional within the expectations and responsibilities of the job. Please note that Elysium OSHC is not responsible for damage to or loss of an employee's articles of clothing, jewellery and/or accessories.

Dress Code

Radical departure from conventional dress or personal grooming is not permitted, as it may serve as a distraction or worse to the children at the Service, parents, and other employees. The following items constitute the basic dress code for employees of the Service. Final determination of the dress code acceptability of an employee's attire shall be determined by the Approved Provider.

Unacceptable dress includes, but is not limited to:
 Short shorts (defined as shorts that come up higher than the tip of your middle finger when your arms are straight at your sides)
 Short dresses or skirts (dresses and skirts above the knee are not acceptable. Do not wear dresses and skirts if it will interfere with your ability to get down on the floor with the children. Shorts should be worn under dresses and skirts as a precaution)
 Low scoop neck shirts or blouses (at no time should undergarments be visible)
 Clothes that expose the stomach
 Clothing with logos and pictures that are inappropriate for children (profanity, sexual innuendoes, violence, drugs, and similar content)
 Jewellery which may present a safety hazard (long necklaces/earrings, etc.)

In addition:
 When wearing low waist pants (hip-huggers, etc) or skirts, staff should wear tops long enough to cover the bottom when bending or squatting. Undergarments should never be visible.
 During swimming activities, staff should wear a one-piece swimsuits or a t-shirt and shorts.

Employees who are found to be in violation of the dress code may be asked to go home and change; the time required to do so is unpaid. A verbal warning will also be given and documented. Second and subsequent violations will result in a written warning, which may be subject to other disciplinary action, up to and including loss of employment.

General Interaction

In general, employees need to maintain a sense of decorum when interacting with others at the Service and observe general rules of proper conduct. Staff are expected to act in a caring, honest, respectful, and responsible manner consistent with Elysium OSHC's mission statement. Staff should always portray a positive role model by maintaining an attitude of loyalty, patience, courtesy, tact, and maturity.

This includes things like:
 Refraining from intimate displays of affection towards others in the presence of children, parents, and other staff.

 Prohibiting profanity, inappropriate jokes, sharing intimate personal details, or any kind of harassment in the presence of children, parents, or other staff.

Staff are required to report any violations by other staff members of these or other policies listed in the handbook to the Approved Provider for possible action. Such reporting is confidential.

Co-worker Interaction

While our employees are encouraged to develop professional and personal connections with one another, gossiping, spreading rumours, and other similar types of negative behaviour are discouraged. Gossip which could affect the ability of the Service or staff to conduct business, maintain good community or employee relations, or otherwise impact Elysium OSHC in a negative way may result in disciplinary action for the employee who has engaged in the conduct.

Families

Families (the children whom we serve, and their parents, guardians, and other family members) are our Service's most valuable asset. Every employee represents Elysium OSHC to our families and to the public.

The manner in which we do our jobs presents an image of our entire organization. Families judge all of us by how they are treated by each and every employee. Nothing is more important than being, respectful, courteous, friendly, helpful, and prompt in the attention given to families.

Our personal contact with the public, our manners on the telephone, and the communications we send to families are a reflection not only of ourselves, but also of the professionalism of Elysium OSHC. Positive interactions with our families not only enhance the public's perception or image of Elysium OSHC, but also help us to obtain grants and contracts.

It is expected that all employees of Elysium OSHC will interact respectfully, courteously, and promptly with our families.

All of the families have the right to their privacy. Do not discuss the children and families publicly or with family members, either by name or physical description. Some of the families have also restricted photography permission for their children; please refer to the Social Media policy listed in this section for more information.

Employees who fail to have appropriate interactions with our families will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Children

We often work with vulnerable families and children's behaviours can be difficult to deal with. Regardless the situation, staff should remember that we are educators and children learn from us. Some general principles are as follows:
 Children have a right to be spoken to with respect. Staff should listen to what the children have to say and respond to the children with respect and consideration.
 Children have a right to be cared about without prejudice. Staff will treat all children equally regardless of sex, race, religion, culture, economic status, or disability.
 Children have a right not to be yelled at or humiliated. Staff will maintain conversational voice levels and should not single out children for exclusion or in a manner which might otherwise overly embarrass the child.
 Children have a right not to be hurt. Staff will maintain a safe environment for the children, and will see to their safety. Staff should intervene to help a child avoid a dangerous or otherwise hurtful situation whenever possible.

 Children have a right to their own privacy. Staff will respect the rights of children to not be touched or looked at in ways which may make the children uncomfortable, and respect the children's right to say no. Children are not to be touched on areas of their bodies that would be covered by a bathing suit.

Phones

Employees are not permitted to make or receive personal telephone calls during work hours unless authorised to do so by the Approved Provider or in the event of an emergency. This includes using one's own mobile phone and/or excessive texting. Mobile phones are not prohibited in the OSHC room, but employees are expected to use them only when appropriate or necessary.

When an employee needs to call a parent, our business line should be used, rather than a personal mobile phone. Every time you make or receive a business telephone call, you are representing not only yourself as a professional, but also Elysium OSHC.

Good telephone techniques to follow include the following:
 If receiving a call, answer promptly and courteously.
 When making or receiving a call, identify yourself clearly and specifically (e.g., "Elysium OSHC, this is Angela speaking," "Hello, this is Angela from Elysium OSHC.")
 Keep your conversation business-like and brief, avoiding prolonged chats.
 Take messages accurately and relay them to the person who was called as soon as possible.
 Answer questions thoroughly to ensure that the caller has received the information requested.
 Close your conversation with a pleasant "Good-bye."

E-Mail And Internet Use

Employees are not permitted to utilize Service computers or internet access for personal reasons, including email, web surfing, and other activities not related to the Service. The use of Service computers to access pornographic websites, send emails of an explicit or sexual nature, or develop online relations of a similar nature is strictly prohibited.

In the event that the Service provides online accounts to employees, such accounts will be reserved for Service-related use only, and all passwords to those accounts will be available to the Approved provider.

In addition, two specific policies address the increasing influence of online interactions are:

Social Media:

The posting of confidential and identifying information about the children, parents, or staff at the Service on social media (e.g., Facebook, MySpace, Twitter, etc.) is strictly prohibited. In no way does Elysium OSHC wish to abridge the rights of its employees to engage in critical commentary and observations that may relate to the Service and its operations; however, when such commentary and observations occur within a public forum and contain confidential information, it may result in disciplinary action for the employee. The posting of non-confidential information (promotional materials and the like) shall be restricted to official channels of communication (the ELYSIUM OSHC website/Facebook page, etc.) unless prior written approval from the Director has been obtained.

Pictures:

As with the use of social media, the publication of photos from the Service, whether online or otherwise, is generally prohibited without prior approval from the Approved Provider.

In general, approval will usually be granted for pictures which advance the Service's mission, demonstrate the educational achievements of the Service or the children in our care, or which otherwise portray the

Service's positive contributions to the community. Staff may take pictures of the activities in their OSHC environments to share with the families of the children in our care, as appropriate (to document a child's Progress/learning, etc.). This is only permitted to be on business devices and through the business apps or online portals.

As mentioned previously, some families have chosen to restrict photograph permissions, and it is expected that all employees will abide by those wishes. These restrictions will be noted on the enrolment form.

Gifts & Gratuities

Employees of Elysium OSHC are prohibited from accepting gifts, money, services, or gratuities from families, vendors, contractors, and all other persons doing business with ELYSIUM OSHC without written permission from the Approved provider. This prohibition also extends to employees giving gifts to the children under their care - toys, video games, jewellery, and the like are inappropriate and/or excessive. In the instance that a gift would be appropriate, approval from the Approved Provider needs to be obtained in advance.

Non-Solicitation

Employees of Elysium OSHC are strictly prohibited from solicitation of any kind while on any ELYSIUM OSHC property without written permission of the Approved Provider. This includes:

Commercial Activities:

During hours of employment, while on Service property, or with the use of Service funds or equipment, employees of ELYSIUM OSHC are prohibited from engaging in commercial solicitations for their own personal gain. In the event that the activity may instead benefit the community, the Service, a charitable organization, or similar entity, the Approved Provider may give prior approval for the activity, subject to limitations determined by the Approved Provider as necessary.

Political Activities:

During hours of employment, while on Service property, or with the use of Service funds or equipment, employees of ELYSIUM OSHC are prohibited from the following:

 Participation in any partisan or non-partisan political activity or any other political activity associated with a candidate, or contending faction or group, for an election for public or party office.
 Participation in any activity to provide voters or prospective voters with transportation to the polls or similar assistance in connection with any such election.
 Participation in any voter registration activity.

Outside Employment

Employees of Elysium OSHC are prohibited from accepting any employment from any family of ELYSIUM OSHC. Employees are specifically prohibited from accepting employment as a babysitter from any family of ELYSIUM OSHC. Exceptions may only be granted by the Approved Provider. All such exceptions shall be made in writing and must be obtained in advance.

Non-Fraternization

At Elysium OSHC, we strive to build relationships with the children in our care and their families, as well as with others we interact with at the Service. While friendships can result from this, it is imperative that employees treat families, vendors, co-workers, and the public with courtesy, appropriate distance, and respect.

Because of the need to maintain appropriate distance, employees of Elysium OSHC are generally prohibited from fraternizing with any family of ELYSIUM OSHC outside of our normal interactions at the Service. While this does not specifically prohibit all contact or interaction between employees and the families we work with, there are some particular items here for consideration.

 Staff may not be alone with children from the Service outside of work. This includes babysitting, sleepovers, driving and riding in cars, and inviting children to their homes. Exceptions require a written explanation in advance and are subject to Approved Provider approval.
 Attending a "social event" or a "private gathering" with a family of ELYSIUM OSHC shall occur only when approved in writing by the Director. This includes birthday parties for the children and other activities.
 Employees should abstain from any intimate physical contact and involvement with families. Employees should also avoid any unwelcome advances and intimate acts made by families. Employees are required to report any unwelcome advances or attempts at intimate acts made by families or co-workers to the Approved provider or manager.
 Employees should abstain from any intimate physical contact or involvement with other employees. This shall include dating other employees. Employees should immediately report any action by a family or employee that would be considered a violation of this policy to the Approved Provider.

HARASSMENT

Elysium OSHC employees, volunteers, families, and applicants have a right to work in a discrimination-free environment, including freedom from sexual harassment. Actions, words, jokes, or comments based on an individual's sex, race, age, ethnicity, religion, or any legally protected characteristic are not tolerated. Both overt and subtle harassment create an offensive, hostile, and uncomfortable work environment and are strictly prohibited. This section concerns any and all types of harassment, with particular attention to the definition of sexual harassment.

Harassment of or by an employee requires investigation. Employees who harass others will be subject to disciplinary action including termination. Sexual harassment is strictly prohibited and will not be tolerated.

Sexual harassment may be defined as, but is not limited to:
 Suggesting to an employee that submitting to sexual favours enhances employment opportunities and/or advancement.
 Threatening or insinuating that refusal to submit to sexual advance will adversely affect employment appraisal, wages, advancement, assigned duties, shifts, or any other condition of employment or career development.
 Unwelcome sexual advances or flirtation.
 Using sexually degrading words.
 Offering sexually suggestive or erotic comments regarding a person's body or mannerisms.
 Displaying graphically sexual pictures and/or objects in the workplace.

All incidents of harassment, sexual or otherwise, need to be reported to the Approved Provider so that the offense may be handled in a manner appropriate to the situation.

Harassment Complaint Procedure

Complaints about sexual and other types of harassment should be reported immediately to the Approved Provider. Sexual harassment complaints will be investigated promptly, and all information will be kept confidential.

PERSONNEL RECORDS

A confidential file will be maintained on each employee containing all employment-related documents such as the employment application, résumé, job and salary history, performance appraisals, disciplinary action, general correspondence, and other documents that pertain to employment at Elysium OSHC.

ELYSIUM OSHC keeps all medically-related information in a separate confidential file. Any false statements made by employees on their employment applications or personnel records will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Employees are prohibited from accessing and removing any documents from their personnel file. Employees may only add documentation to their personnel file with the permission of the Approved Provider.

Employee requests for copies of the documents contained in the personnel file must be made in writing to the Approved Provider.

CONFIDENTIALITY

This Confidentiality Policy has been adopted to insure the confidentiality and protection of individual rights of privacy for children, families, and employees of Elysium OSHC.

The individual dignity of children, families, and employees shall be respected and protected at all times in accordance with all applicable laws. Information about children, families, or employees will not be divulged to anyone other than persons who are authorised to receive such information. This policy extends to both internal and external disclosure of information.

An employee’s responsibility to maintain confidentiality regarding information learned about children, their parents/guardians, families, and other employees applies 24 hours per day, 7 days per week regardless of how or where the information was obtained. Employees must be diligent in their efforts to maintain confidentiality, and should be aware that there are job related consequences for violations of confidentiality and rights of privacy, and that there is the potential for civil and criminal liability against the individual employee and the Service.

Confidentiality of Children's and Families' Information

 All children's private records (home address, medical file, etc.) must be locked in a secure environment.
 OSHC binders are not considered private records, but will only contain information specific and necessary to the care of each individual child. Access to OSHC binders is restricted to staff members who work in that specific OSHC Service or the Approved Provider.
 Access to children's records is limited to employees with a “need to know.”
 Children's records must not be removed from the Service.
 Children's records must never be left out on desks, tables, etc. where others may have access to them.
 Children's or families’ private information must never be discussed among employees except on a "need to know" basis. Employees must be particularly aware of their surroundings when discussing this information. Special caution must be taken to ensure other children, families, or employees do not overhear information that is confidential.
 Discussion of children's or families' information with volunteers, other families, friends, or community members is prohibited.
 Information and documents which are considered to be confidential include, but are not limited to, medical records, educational records, special needs records, family records, financial records, and any other private information about the children or their families.
 All requests for release of information shall be made to the Approved Provider.
 Information will only be released to persons outside of ELYSIUM OSHC with the express written consent of the child's parent or legal guardian.

Confidentiality of Employee's Information

 All employee records must be locked in a secure file.
 General access to an employee's records is limited to the Approved provider.
 An employee's records must not be removed from the Service.
 An employee's records must never be left out on desks, tables, etc. where other people may have access to them.
 An employee's private information will never be discussed among employees except on a "need to know" basis. Employees must be particularly aware of their surroundings when discussing this information. Special caution must be taken to ensure children, families, or employees do not overhear information that is confidential.
 Discussion of an employee's information with volunteers, families, friends, or community members is prohibited.
 Information and documents which are considered to be confidential include, but are not limited to, medical records, educational records, employment records, financial or pay records, and any other private information about the employee.
 All requests for release of information to persons outside of ELYSIUM OSHC shall be made to the Approved Provider.
 Information will only be released to persons outside ELYSIUM OSHC with the express written consent of the employee.

Confidentiality Related to Proprietary Information

Elysium OSHC has developed unique techniques, curricula, and tools for evaluation which make our program more competitive in the industry and are not to be revealed to sources outside of the company.

Anything which the company designs, produces, implements, and markets is treated as proprietary information. This includes, but is not be limited to, the Service's family list, employee list, curriculum, philosophy, mission statement, personnel policies, and employee/parent handbooks.

No employee should discuss proprietary information with other employees in any public place where such information could be overheard. Employees should also not provide others with any documents relating to this propriety information. Employees must understand that it is not only their duty to protect Elysium OSHC's proprietary information during their term of employment, but that this legal obligation continues even after separation from employment. Employees are required to return any and all documentation that contains proprietary information at the time of separation. This obligation may be enforced through court action, if necessary.

Violation of Confidentiality Policy

Any employee/volunteer who violates the Confidentiality Policy will be subject to disciplinary action including termination. In addition to job-related consequences, the employee/volunteer may face possible civil and criminal liability for their actions.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Conflicts can arise between employees, employees and families, and the like. In the event that two or more parties find themselves in a situation where conflict is inevitable or has already occurred, has affected or will affect the Service and its operation, and can be potentially resolved through the actions of the Service, procedures have been established to ensure that all parties to any conflict receive fair and equal hearing to help resolve the circumstances surrounding the issue. This process is described in the Policies and Procedures Manual.

Terminated/Former Employees are not eligible to participate in the Conflict Resolution process.

DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

In the event that an employee is found to be in violation of one or more policies outlined in this handbook, the disciplinary process may be initiated. While this is generally a process of escalating actions, certain violations may be more egregious in their severity, frequency of occurrence, and/or scope, and thus could warrant a disciplinary action higher on the list, up to and including termination of duties. The determination of the specific disciplinary action to be undertaken is at the discretion of the Approved Provider, and will be appropriate to the nature of the offense.

Reprimand

A reprimand may be given to any employee when a minor violation of Service policies or procedures has occurred. A reprimand may be either verbal or written. Verbal reprimands will be documented by the Approved Provider, and the documentation will be placed in the employee's personnel file. Written reprimands will include brief documentation of the incident and the date on which it occurred. Written reprimands require that a copy of the written reprimand be given to the employee, and a copy of the reprimand signed by the employee to acknowledge receipt of the document must be placed in the employee's file.

Written Warning

For more serious violations of policies and procedures, or repeated minor violations, an employee may be given a written warning. The written warning will clearly describe the deficiency in the performance or conduct, and will cite the policy, licensing regulation, or procedure violated. The written warning will contain a corrective action plan, outlining the necessary action(s) to correct the deficiency and a timetable in which the corrective action must occur.

A copy of the written warning and the corrective action plan will be given to the employee. Employees are required to sign a copy of the written warning, acknowledging its receipt, which will then be placed in the employee's personnel file. Signing the written warning does not indicate that the employee agrees with the contents; it simply indicates receipt of a copy of the written warning. Failure or refusal to sign the written warning will be considered insubordination and will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Copies of all documentation regarding corrective action plans will be retained by the Approved Provider.

Investigatory Suspension

For suspected severe, but unconfirmed allegations of policy and procedure violations, the Approved Provider may initiate an Investigatory Suspension of the employee. During this time, the employee is suspended without pay. The outcome of an investigatory suspension is generally either full reinstatement (if the employee is found not to be in violation of the policies) or further disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Examples of situations which would warrant use of Investigatory suspension include, but are not limited to:
- Charges of driving while intoxicated
- Report of child abuse or neglect
- Accusations of theft
- Violation of the Substance Abuse Policy
- Other similar situations

Investigatory suspension may not exceed 10 working days without the approval of the Approved Provider.

Suspension

Suspension of an employee may occur at the discretion of the Approved Provider for specific, major infractions of the Personnel Policies. Suspension of an employee will not require prior verbal or written disciplinary action. Suspension may be used in circumstances where a confirmed violation of policies is not considered severe enough to warrant termination of employment, and where the employee can be successfully rehabilitated to effectively discharge the duties of the position. Possible violations are similar to those on both the list for Investigatory Suspension and Termination, though certain violations are still subject to immediate termination of employment, without recourse to an initial suspension.

Each situation is different and will be treated as such. Suspension will be without pay. The employee will be notified in writing of the specific charges and the length of the suspension, and will be provided with a copy of this notice. The employee is required to sign a copy of the suspension notification to acknowledge receipt of same. Failure to sign the suspension notification will be considered insubordination and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

When circumstances permit, an employee will be suspended upon receipt of the suspension notification. However, an employee may be suspended verbally if immediate suspension is in the best interest of Elysium OSHC, its employees, or the children under the Service's care. Written notification in these circumstances will promptly follow via certified mail or email. Suspension by verbal notice may be given by the Approved Provider, followed immediately by written approval of the Approved Provider.

Termination

Involuntary termination does not necessarily require prior verbal or written disciplinary action if there is an immediate risk to the children, employees or families. This policy is to be used as a guide for employees, but is not inclusive of all possible reasons or causes for termination from employment. Termination is an action which must be approved by the Approved Provider. Notification of Termination may be written or verbal.

Causes for involuntary termination include, but are not limited to, the following:
 Unsatisfactory provisional period
 Falsifying or misusing records, including application
 Violation of confidentiality rules
 Theft or misuse of Elysium OSHC funds, equipment, or property
 Absence from work without notification and/or approval as per related policies
 Discourteous treatment of the public, families, or co-workers
 Inappropriate behaviour
 Non-performance of duties resulting in injury to the Service, its children, families, or employees.
 Being abusive or neglectful to children, parents, or employees
 Violation of the Substance Abuse Policy
 Failure to submit required documentation within mandated time frame
 Neglect of duty or refusal to comply with directives of the Approved Provider
 Misuse of leave policies
 Insubordination
 Receipt of 2 suspensions for the same infraction during any 12 month period.
 Failure to implement job specifics
 Receipt of 3 written warnings for any violations during any 12 month period; the date of the third warning will be the employee's last day of employment
 Failure to return to work following a leave of absence
 Failure to meet deadlines as presented by the Approved Provider

Once employment has been terminated under this action, the employee is expected to return any keys and other property of the Service to the Approved Provider, and leave the Service at that time. The former

employee will be escorted out of the building, and is no longer permitted on Elysium OSHC property without the written approval of the Approved Provider.

Any of the former employee's personal property or effects which remain at Service will be packed and shipped to the former employee's home address. The former employee's final pay slip(s) will be mailed to that address as well, and may not be picked up at the Service. All final pay slip will be sent on the scheduled paydays for the pay period applicable for the hours worked.

RESIGNATION

Although we want every employee to stay with us for as long as possible, sometimes new opportunities arise that an employee may wish to explore. While we do not wish to hinder our employees from pursuing these endeavours, we also ask that our employees provide ample opportunity for us to seek suitable replacements for the departing employee. As such, employees are required to give two (2) weeks' notice of the intention to terminate employment. Notice must be given in writing to the Approved Provider. If submitted by any other method other than directly to the Approved provider, the two week period begins upon receipt of the notice by the Approved Provider, not when the notice was mailed or otherwise sent. Unused vacation or leave time may not be used as part of the required two weeks' notice.

Employees who give the required notice will be entitled to payment of accumulated leave time, provided all Service equipment and property has been returned. Employees who fail to give the required notice will forfeit payment for any accrued, unused vacation time.

In general, an employee's final pay slip(s) will be sent to the home address listed in the employee's file on the regularly scheduled pay dates for the hours worked.

EMPLOYMENT REFERENCES

Elysium OSHC will release information regarding positions held and length of employment for reference purposes. In order to release any additional information regarding employment, the employee must provide a signed release. Confidential information will only be provided with the employee's express written permission. All requests for references must be in writing.

Unless specifically authorised by the Approved Provider, employees are strictly prohibited from providing references for any employee under any circumstance, including a personal reference.

II. GENERAL DUTIES

This section of the handbook details the basic duties, expectations, and general policies for all employees. This is not all-inclusive of all possible duties which may be assigned; these are basic guidelines to follow. Please note that OSHC space-specific policies are contained in another section of this handbook.

SERVICE OPERATION
These policies govern specific expectations for the Service's day-to-day operations. Many procedures are explained in greater depth in the Service binders or are posted to specific OSHC spaces.

Opening/Closing Procedures
Staff are expected to know the standard opening and closing procedures for the Service and for their specific OSHC spaces. These procedures are listed in the site instructions document located in the operations folder. Please note that these are specific duties which must be completed and indicated as such each day as noted. In the event that one or more of these duties have not been completed on a particular day, the staff member should notify the Approved Provider of the deficiency.

General Housekeeping
Employees are responsible for a variety of housekeeping duties. Most of these are particular to your OSHC space, but some duties will require you to help with the upkeep of other areas if accessed by the Service. There is no formal list for these duties. Refer to communication methods for further instructions.

 Cleaning surfaces
- Eating areas/all surfaces where food and dishes may be prepared or placed must be cleaned with soap and water or another cleaner, and then sanitized prior to use.
- Playing surfaces: all shelves and toys should be cleaned according to the cleaning schedule.

 Sanitizing
Spray sanitizer on item or surface and let it sit on the item for one minute then wipe clean. The cleaning schedule will provide more information about what to sanitize.

Personal Property/Effects
Any personal property and effects (purses, backpacks, etc.) should generally be left in your vehicle, locked up, or put in the office while you are at work. Such items are not allowed in the OSHC space unless locked up securely and inaccessible to any children under your care.

If an employee chooses to bring in personal property for use in the OSHC room, prior approval from the Approved Provider should be obtained whenever possible, unless the item is something generally used within the classroom already and a replacement is needed (e.g., glue, paint, crayons). Employees will not be reimbursed for such items unless the purchase is approved in advance by the Approved Provider.

CHILDREN'S HEALTH
Elysium OSHC takes the health of the children in our care very seriously. The policies below are our general expectations and procedures for various situations within your OSHC space and outside of it.

Food and Meals
Meals are an important time for the children. It is a social time as well as a time for nutrition. As you will be present with the children, your attitude about food and meals will be reflected in the children. Your manners and etiquette are important. You teach by example. If you say that a food is disgusting, the children will believe you and imitate your feelings, not their own. Our menus are created to meet state nutrition guidelines and to provide healthy choices for the children.

Food handling policy:
Elysium OSHC follows state guidelines for food handling, as required by law. You will be expected to set up and serve the snacks and meals to your room. Before handling any food, you should wash your hands with soap and water. Each utensil can only be used for one type of food. For example, we can use tongs for all fruits, but when we add meat to the meal, a different set of tongs must be used (the same utensil cannot be shared between the two dishes). The entire meal does not have to be placed on the table prior to a child sitting in front of his/her plate. *Loss of meal and/or snack privileges may NOT be used as part of any unrelated disciplinary process.*

Illness
Illnesses don't just affect the child who is ill; anyone who comes into contact with the child may also contract the illness. As such, employees must be aware of how to recognize the signs and symptoms of possible illness, and how to address those situations when they occur. If a child shows signs of illness, those symptoms should be reported immediately to the Coordinator. In some cases, the child will be sent home until the illness has passed.

Recognizing
A child who shows any sign of the following should be reported to the Coordinator for observation:
 Fever above 38°C
 Vomiting
 Rash (other than heat)

 Diarrhea
 Infectious mucus (green)
 Conjunctivitis (pink eye)
 Breathing difficulties
This is not an all-inclusive list. Please refer to the Policies and Procedures Manual for a more extensive list.

Procedures for Sick Children
Once a sick child's symptoms have been reported to the Coordinator, the determination will be made as to whether the child should be sent home. Staff should not make the initial determination. If the child is determined to be sick, the parent(s) of the child will be contacted to make arrangements to pick the child up from the Service. The child will remain separated from the other children at the Service until he/she is picked up.

If a sick child is sent home, the child will not be allowed to return until either the child no longer has the symptoms, begins a course of treatment for the illness, or otherwise appears to be well enough to attend the Service. A child sent home will generally not be allowed to return on the same day.

Medication
You may be required to administer medication to a child in your care. Please note the following guidelines:
 Each medication has to have a signed permission slip. You may NOT administer any medication to a child unless there is signed permission on file for the medication.
 Medication should be kept in an area where children should not be able to access.
 For medications to be administered close to or during a meal time, make a separate note as a reminder.
 Document the time(s) at which you give the child the medicine.
 If medicine is given for a fever, take the child's temperature 30 minutes after the medicine is given.

Allergies
Some of the children under your care may have allergies to specific foods or other allergens. It is your responsibility to be aware of these allergies and take appropriate precautionary measures to ensure the health and safety of those children. Any allergies will be noted with the enrolment form for the child.
 Food allergies: If any children in your classroom have a food allergy (milk, peanuts, etc.), great precaution should be used to not accidentally serve the child this food. In some cases, the food item will not be offered on the menu at all.
 Asthma: Can be triggered by allergies. If you have animals at home, the child may have a reaction to your clothing. It may be helpful to change into other clothes upon your arrival at the Service or wear an apron so that exposure is limited. The use of perfume or air freshener, extremely hot or cold weather, seasonal allergies (pollen), and dust can also trigger an asthma attack. Immediately notify the Coordinator if a child is having breathing difficulties.
 Other allergens: Children may have other types of allergies. Specific precautionary measures will be provided as needed and noted on the medical action plan and communication plan.

Handwashing
Proper handwashing helps curb the spread of disease and promotes general hygiene. By modeling these behaviors for the children under your care, and insisting that they follow the same process, you help to ensure the health of everyone you encounter.
 Turn water on and wait for water to be warm
 Lather soap on your hands
 Rinse and scrub hands for 15 seconds
 Towel dry hands
 Use a disposable paper/hand towel if you are using the toilet or assisting a child with toileting

Universal Precautions
All employees are required to strictly adhere to Universal Precautions Procedures to control exposure to Bloodborne Pathogens (discussed below) and other hazards, and to promote good hygiene.

To assist in this, Elysium OSHC provides vinyl/latex gloves in a variety of sizes and CPR guards as personal protective equipment for the use of the employees; these items are located in the first aid bag. Employees are required to have personal protective equipment in their immediate area at all times

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When traveling outside of the classroom area, employees are required to carry the First-Aid pack at all times. Employees are required to use the personal protective equipment in each and every instance warranted by this and other policies and procedures, in the manner in which the personal protective equipment is intended for use. Failure to appropriately use personal protective equipment at any time will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Bloodborne Pathogens

During your employment at the Service you may, in the course of your daily activities, come into contact with potentially infectious materials. Those situations may include, but are not limited to, the following:

 Providing assistance after an accident has occurred with children, employees, parents and/or volunteers.

 Assisting children during medical procedures, i.e., first-aid, nose bleeds, times of illness, administration of medication, etc.

 Diapering children or cleaning up after a child has a toileting accident.

 Handling of contaminated items such as soiled clothing, tissues, and diapers.

 Cleaning up and handling broken glass and/or sharp objects.

While not all of the above situations are inherently dangerous, failure to follow universal precautions (using the appropriate protective gear) places the employee and others at risk. Thus, for your own safety and the safety of others, all employees are required to treat all children and fellow employees as though they might be infected with a bloodborne pathogen, regardless of a known medical condition, how they look, or what is known about their lifestyle. Persons infected with bloodborne pathogens do not look a certain way, act in a particular fashion, are a certain age or lead particular lifestyles. Persons with a bloodborne pathogen disease are not required to disclose their illness to the employees or administration of Elysium OSHC, as such information is confidential and protected by law.

Common bloodborne pathogens include, but are not limited to: HIV, hepatitis, syphilis, and herpes. These and other bloodborne pathogens are transmitted primarily through human blood and other potentially infected materials (OPIMs), which include, but are not limited to: semen, vaginal secretions, feces, urine, or any other bodily fluid that may contain blood.

Exposure and Incident Reporting

Because of the nature of the job, routine contact with some OPIMs will occur with some regularity. Employees must:

 Always wear personal protective equipment (gloves) when changing diapers, cleaning up accidents, etc.

 Report any incident where the employee comes in direct contact with blood or OPIMs, either through unprotected skin contact or a breach in the protective gear (e.g., a torn or broken glove)

Reporting an incident involves

 Notifying the Coordinator/Approved Provider of the direct exposure to/contact with blood or OPIMs, as noted above

 Completion of an Exposure Control Incident Report

These actions should be completed within one (1) hour of the exposure incident. Failure to report an exposure incident and/or complete and turn in the Exposure Control Incident Report as outlined will result in disciplinary action, as noted elsewhere in this document.

Within 24 hours of an exposure incident, Elysium OSHC will provide, at its own expense, laboratory tests (including testing the employee's blood), a Hepatitis B vaccination (if the employee has not been previously vaccinated against Hepatitis B), and a medical evaluation performed by a licensed medical professional for the employee, to help ensure and protect the overall health of the employee. The employee has the right to

decline any or all of the above, if desired. An Exposure Control Consent Form must be filled out indicating the employee's choice regarding testing and other medical care.

Employees should be mindful of blood or OPIM on their clothing or personal items. Contaminated clothing and personal items must be cleaned and/or disposed of in a manner to ensure that further exposure does not occur. This may require that an employee's clothing be torn or cut off and/or thrown away. Elysium OSHC is not responsible for clothing or personal items ruined or destroyed as a result of contamination and/or removal as per this policy.

CHILD SAFETY
Elysium OSHC does everything possible to provide a safe environment for our employees and the children in our care. As such, some items are prohibited from being used at or brought to the Service. Other policies and procedures govern specific situations dealing with safety before, during, or after an incident has occurred.

Prohibited Items
Certain items are prohibited from being brought into our classrooms and the Service:
 Glass containers (except in the kitchen area and other areas designated by the Approved Provider)
 Weapons
 Any other item which might reasonably compromise the safety or health of the children in our care, employees, or visitors to the Service

Emergency Evacuation Procedures
Evacuation routes are posted in each OSHC room, noting the specific exits for that room in case of an emergency that requires staff and children to leave the Service. While an emergency situation can be quite chaotic, you need to maintain a calm and level head, regardless of the situation.

Emergency (Leaving the Service)
In the event of an emergency which requires leaving the Service (during a fire, for instance), you should:
 Gather up the enrolment folder, digital roll device and first aid pack
 Take the children to the designated evacuation area
 Take attendance and report any missing children or staff to the Coordinator/Approved Provider immediately

This procedure should be followed in the event of any real or perceived emergency, even if the event is a scheduled drill.

Emergency (Remaining at the Service)
For emergencies where leaving the Service would be unsafe (such as during a hazardous weather warning), you should:
 Gather up the enrolment folder, digital roll device and first aid pack
 Go to the designated Safe Area listed for the particular emergency
 Take attendance and report any missing children or staff to the Coordinator/Approved Provider

Please note that parents are prohibited from picking up their children during this kind of emergency! While the parent is permitted to join the child in the designated Safe Area, you may advise the parent to remain but are not permitted to force the decision.

This procedure should be followed in the event of any real or perceived emergency, even if the event is a scheduled drill.

Accidents
Accidents or injuries involving children must be reported immediately to the Coordinator. Employees should not contact the parent(s) until the Approved Provider has been notified of the accident. Employees will be

advised by the Approved Provider to call the child's parents to apprise them of the incident/accident as necessary. If an accident causes the child to bruise or bleed, the parent will be notified immediately once the Approved Provider has been informed of the incident, even if the accident is not serious. It is important to think about how you would feel if you picked your child up at the end of the day and you were not notified of a bruise or serious cut.

When an accident involving one of the children under our care occurs, the employee must fill out an Accident/Injury Report immediately following the incident. Three copies will be made. One copy will be given to the Approved Provider, another to be kept at the service, and the last copy will be given to the parent. The parent copy must be signed by and given to the parent(s) within 24 hours following the incident/accident.

Accidents involving parents or visitors must be reported immediately to the Approved Provider. Employees are required to complete Accident/Injury reports for these incidents. The report will be given to the Approved Provider. The document will become part of the service's record. Any employee who fails to appropriately report an accident or injury, or who purposefully files a false report will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Other Emergencies
While no policy can cover every contingency, you are expected to follow all rules from CPR and First Aid training, as well as Universal Precautions, in any emergency which may necessitate the use of such training. When blood or other bodily fluids are involved, you are expected to use gloves in handling the situation. If immediate medical attention is needed for a child or another staff member, call 000 before administering assistance, whenever possible.

Behavioural Incidents
Behavioural incidents between children may also occur where one child hurts or attempts to hurt another child at the Service, and the incident leaves a mark. While some of these are relatively mild, all such incidents should be documented as noted:

Behavioural Incident (General):
This kind of incident usually involves two or more children engaging in behaviour against one another which would not be considered acceptable - e.g., Child A throws a toy at Child B, leaving a mark. The incident must be documented for both children. Identifying information for each child involved should only be placed on that child's form - in the example above, the name of Child A (who threw the toy) would only go on Child A's form. The name of Child B would only go on Child B's form. Under no circumstances are employees allowed to acknowledge which child hurt another in writing, verbally, or non-verbally (pointing, nodding one's head, etc.).

Biting Incident*:*
For all children, use the Behavioural Incident form. As with the previous form, the Biting Incident must be documented for both children, withholding the identifying information as noted above. If the bite draws blood, the Approved Provider needs to be notified immediately, regardless of the age of the children involved.

ABUSE AND NEGLECT
While Elysium OSHC provides a safe environment for children, other types of harm may come to a child despite our best precautions. In particular, the abuse or neglect of a child is of paramount concern.
To this end, all staff are required to read and sign all policies relating to identifying, documenting, and reporting child abuse. Mandatory training sessions on the subject are required.
Mandated Reporting Of Suspected Child Abuse And Neglect Under the Child Protective Services Act, mandated reporters are required to report any suspicion of abuse or neglect to the appropriate authorities. ***ALL EMPLOYEES of Elysium OSHC are considered mandated reporters in this context and will make their reports to the Approved Provider.***

In the case of suspected abuse or neglect, you are asked to inform the Coordinator prior to making a report to the Approved Provider. If you feel that the Approved Provider is not adequately protecting the child, you can call the **Department of Health and Human** Services and report the incident anonymously. Remember that abuse and neglect are serious allegations.

The following guidelines contain information relating to child abuse. It is extremely important to make yourself familiar with the information, especially the parts pertaining to the characteristics of battered children and the indicators of child neglect. If you have any suspicions or concerns regarding a child, please get in touch with the Approved Provider and begin to keep a record of items which may indicate abuse of the child.

General reasons for reporting suspected child abuse/neglect include, but are not limited to:
 Unusual bruising, marks, or cuts on the child's body
 Witnessing severe verbal reprimands from the parent
 Improper clothing relating to size, cleanliness, season
 Transporting a child without appropriate child restraints (e.g., car seats, seat belts)
 Dropping off/Picking up a child while under the influence of illegal drugs/alcohol
 Not providing appropriate meals, including a drink, for the child
 Leaving a child unattended for any amount of time
 Failure to attend to the special needs of a disabled child
 Sending a sick child to school over-medicated to hide symptoms which would typically require the child to be kept at home until symptoms subside
 Children who exhibit other behaviour consistent with an abusive situation

Characteristics Of Battered Children
Abused children endure life as if they are alone in a dangerous world, with no real hope of safety. Feeling unprotected, abused children try to protect themselves in any way they can. When a child has been injured and is brought for treatment, the child usually appears to:
 Have no close feelings or affection with parents or other people.
 Be fearful or quiet.
 Show no reaction to pain or expectation of being comforted.

Having had violent physical contact with adults in the past, the child is often *wary of physical contact initiated by an adult.* When admitted to a hospital ward, the battered child *seems less afraid than other children and settles in quickly.* When other children cry, the battered child becomes *apprehensive and watches them with curiosity.*
The battered child will also become *apprehensive when an adult approaches the crying child.* While in a new situation, the child s*eeks safety in sizing up the situation and being alert for danger.*
Children who have been battered do not generally behave as typical children do. *They display many adult-like reactions.*

Indicators of Child Neglect
Neglect is a form of abuse. There are various characteristics that can describe child neglect in general, but for clarity, neglect can be divided into two subgroups - physical and emotional neglect. These two aspects contribute to each other and rarely occur separately. The following are characteristics that may indicate physical neglect:
 Malnourished
 Ill-clad or dirty
 Overcrowded or unhealthy sleeping arrangements
 Receiving inadequate supervision
 Totally unsupervised

Many of the abovementioned characteristics may also indicate emotional neglect, along with:
 Insecurity, seemingly withdrawn or overaggressive

 Failure to attend school regularly
 Constant friction in the home
 Exposure to unwholesome and demoralizing circumstances
 Denied normal nurturance

Any person who reports abuse or neglect, pursuant to the law, or testifies in a child abuse hearing resulting from such a report is immune from any criminal or civil liability as a result of such action. As mandated reporters, employees of Elysium OSHC cannot be held liable for reports made to Child Protective Services which are ultimately determined to be unfounded, provided the report was made in "good faith."

PENALTY FOR FAILURE TO REPORT
Any person who knowingly fails to report suspected abuse or neglect, pursuant to the law or to comply with the provisions of the law, may be subject to **removal of position and withdrawal of WWCC, fine or imprisonment.**

III. OSHC ROOM MANAGEMENT AND CURRIULUM

This section of the handbook deals with policies governing our OSHC rooms, as well as information about our curriculum and how to contribute to it.

GENERAL CLASSROOM PROCEDURES AND GUIDELINES
The following are general principles and rules to follow with the children in your OSHC room. From the moment a child arrives at the Service to the moment the child leaves the Service's property, we have a responsibility to ensure the child's safety and to appropriately conduct ourselves around the children and others.

Children Entering/Exiting the Building
It is your responsibility to make sure that the children do not leave the building without the approval of a responsible adult. No child should be playing outside alone. We are responsible for the child until the family signs the child out – taking responsibility for the child. Even if the family member says it is ok, it isn't. Just simply tell the parent that the child's safety is our concern and that the child cannot leave the building without approval.

Child Drop Off and Pick Up
You need to be prepared when parents drop off children and pick them up. The following procedures are designed to ensure a certain level of interaction each day with our families and promote a consistent process for parents, children, and employees.

Drop off: When a child is dropped off at the Service, please do the following:
 Greet the family upon their arrival.
 Each day a basic health check should be conducted on each child upon arrival, noting any fever, bumps, bruises, burns, and other signs and symptoms of ill health. Questions and comments about anything noted should be addressed to the parent or child in a non-threatening way. Any questionable marks or responses should be documented in writing and submitted to the Approved Provider.
 Obtain information that will help you care for the child; e.g., 'Has he had breakfast?' 'How did she sleep last night?' 'Did you have fun with whatever activity you planned yesterday?'
 Help the child say goodbye and get the child involved in an activity.
 Be sure to mark down that the child has attended that day, and make notes for the afternoon about the child if needed.
 If the child has any medications, these should be given to the Coordinator at this time to be placed in an appropriate location

Pick up: When a child is picked up at the Service, please do the following:
 Greet the family upon their arrival.
 If you are unsure of the identity of the person who has arrived to pick up the child(ren), check the adult's identification card against the pick up list, even if the child seems to know the adult. Only those individuals formally authorized in writing by the parent/guardian are permitted to take a child from the Service. This is further discussed below.
 Tell the family about something good that happened. Discuss challenges, but don't make it a habit of making the family feel bad about the child's behaviour.
 Make sure the family has all papers, projects, notes, etc. that are intended to go home with the child.
 Say goodbye.

Pick Up Permission List
Each child's enrolment form notes the approved pick up people. If an adult is not on that list, the child may not go home until contact with the parent has been made.

Consent for individuals NOT on the list To pick up the child may be obtained verbally, via telephone, SMS, email or any other method of communication. Information needed will be the full name on a driver's licence of the individual picking up the child. The child recognising the adult is not enough.

Keep in mind that some individuals may not be allowed to have contact with the child through court order, and the Service will have a copy of that order and note this on the pick up permission list.

UNDER NO CIRCUMSTANCES IS A CHILD TO LEAVE THE SERVICE WITH SOMEONE WHO IS NOT ON THE PERMISSION LIST. Employees who release a child to a person who is not on the pick up list may be subject to immediate termination.

Intoxication and Picking Up Children
It is our policy to not release a child to any person who is or seems to be intoxicated or impaired. In any situation where a person who is intoxicated or impaired tries to pick up a child from the Service, please notify the appropriate authorities, followed by the Approved Provider immediately. If the intoxicated person leaves the Service with the child, the call the Police.

Excursions
From time to time, excursions may be planned to enrich the learning experiences of our children. All excursions must be approved in advance by the Approved Provider, and information about the specifics for the trip (when, where, cost, travel arrangements) must be submitted before approval can be granted.

Written permission from a child's parent(s) is needed prior to the child going on the excursion. The roll, permission slips, risk assessment form and first aid pack must be brought on all field trips.

If taking a car:
 All children must wear seat belts and, be in car seats if necessary.
 Children will enter and exit on the curb side of the vehicle.
If taking a bus or train:
 All children must sit together on the bus or train.
 We do not eat or chew gum on the bus or train.
 We must keep our inside voices on.
 Children do not get up until the teacher says to get up
General excursion rules:
 Children do not talk about others in public that are not a part of the group.
 No one should hurt anyone or anything.
 If a child breaks a rule, that child may not go on the next trip.

Child Interaction
While general guidelines for interacting with children are in the preceding section, this covers a few, more specific items.
The children are our number one priority. Make sure that you make time each day for them. Make time for positive attention and praise. Have plenty of eye contact – bend down to their level and talk to them. Don't yell across the room if at all possible. Be involved with what the children are doing. Take the time to work on puzzles with them, talking with them, and engaging in other appropriate activities. Be a part of the things that they do.

At no time should any staff person be alone with a single child where the staff member cannot be observed by others. You should always take care in such situations to position yourself so that other staff can see you. In addition, no staff member shall ever leave a child unsupervised.

Restroom Supervision
You must ensure that the restroom is not occupied by anyone (suspicious/unknown individuals) before allowing a child to use the facilities. You should stand in the doorway of the restroom while the child is using the facilities to ensure privacy for the children and protect yourself (not being alone with a child). When you assist younger children, the doors to the facility must remain open. No child, regardless of age, shall enter a restroom alone on excursions or at other off-site locations. Children should always be sent in threes and, whenever possible, with a staff member. Private activities (diapering, changing clothing, putting on swimwear, taking showers, etc) should be conducted or supervised in pairs. When this is not feasible, you should position yourself to be visible to others.

Abuse
You shall not abuse children in any way, including:
 Physical abuse - striking, spanking, shaking, slapping, etc.
 Verbal abuse - using words that threaten, humiliate, degrade, etc.
 Sexual abuse - touching or speaking inappropriately
 Mental abuse - shaming, withholding kindness, being cruel, etc.
 Neglect - withholding food, water, or any other type of basic care

Parent Interaction
While general guidelines for interacting with parents (and other members of the general public) are in the preceding sections, this covers a few, more specific items.
 In general, talk to the parents whenever possible. We need to maintain open lines of communication with them at all times.
 Daily communication is required, as noted in the Drop Off and Pick Up procedures.
 Take every opportunity to discuss with the parent(s) what positive things the child has done that day.
 If there has been a behavioural issue, try not to discuss the child's negative behaviour in front of the child (or other children and families). Be sure to emphasize how you addressed the situation (as discussed later in this section).

Snacking/Drinking
Discreet snacking in the OSHC room is permitted, as is drinking water or other drinks. Please keep such snacks and drinks out of the reach of any children in the room. Employees should not share their own snacks and drinks with the children.

OSHC room Observers:
At times observers will visit your OSHC room. Please treat them with respect - your actions reflect on the Service as a whole. Answer questions to the best of your ability, but don't speculate about questions to which you do not know the answer. Remember that any time there is an observer, your OSHC room should run as scheduled. The children come first.

Some agencies and individuals are there to ensure that we are in compliance with state and other regulations regarding child care Services. Others may observe your OSHC room for different reasons - to learn more about the Service, learn more about child care in general, or provide other accreditations.

YOUR OSHC ROOM

There are many components that go into making your OSHC room a safe and fun learning environment for the children at Elysium OSHC. You will be provided with a wide range of materials to help you maintain and develop appropriate lessons and curricula for the children in your service, along with other items containing important information about the children under your care.

OSHC Folders

Each service has a folders with specific information about the children assigned to that site, as well as listing policies and procedures for the Service. Some of that information includes:

Child Information

Before you watch children on your own in a service, you need to familiarise yourself with medical information, court orders and other specific needs of each child. The enrolment form contains most of this information. Make sure you read about their likes and dislikes, fears, security or cuddle items, allergies, etc. You will need to know the things in the enrolment form so you can better care for the children.

Pick Up Permission List

As noted in the previous section, this is a list of people who have been approved to pick up a particular child and contained within the enrolment form.

Emergency Information

Emergency contact information for that child.

Daily Schedules and Routines

A daily schedule allows the children to know what is coming next. It helps to build a classroom routine for the children. A daily schedule allows for outside play, meals, snacks, free play, small group play, and large group play. Each schedule must be posted in plain view. It is understandable that at times your schedule will vary from what is posted, but in general you should follow your schedule.

If you come into your service later in the day to take over duties from another educator, be sure to find out what events may have already occurred that day or other information which you may need to be aware of. This includes things like:

- New medication for a child
- Parent communications
- Alterations to or omission of lessons
- Other significant events

CURRICULUM

At Elysium OSHC, our curriculum encourages learning through play, using a variety of activities and techniques to reach particular goals.

Our developmentally appropriate curriculum provides for the whole child; it combines physical, emotional, social, and cognitive learning through an integrated approach. Each of these domains is interconnected and impacts the others.

Children learn by doing. Through active involvement with their environment, children attempt to make sense of the world around them. They learn by exploring their environment through hands-on experience. Teaching young children is a creative process. An early childhood curriculum provides the framework for what actually happens in a planned environment where children interact with materials, peers, and adults.

The primary teaching goal is to help young children use the environment productively and see themselves as capable learners. They will acquire the skills and abilities needed for a lifetime of learning through carefully planned, developmentally appropriate activities arranged by the educators. When a learning environment encourages exploration and discovery, children develop a sense of trust and belonging. They feel important and valued when others listen to them, seek out their ideas, and allow them to express themselves. This type of environment is considered hands-on or learning through play.

Children in our services are encouraged to discover things on their own. They learn by exploring the actual objects we talk about. The educators inspire the children by asking open-ended questions and finding new ways to teach new things within the subject area.

Developmentally Appropriate Practices
Our educators use developmentally appropriate practices to nurture the social, emotional, physical, and cognitive development of each child. The theories of early childhood education are used to implement the curriculum. Assessments are done to identify the strengths of each child as well as the needs of each child. These assessments help us to tailor the curriculum to the needs of each classroom.

Age Appropriateness
Human development research indicates that there are universal, predictable sequences of growth and change that occur in children during the first nine years of life. These predictable changes occur in all domains of development – physical, cognitive, emotional, and social. Knowledge of the typical development of children within the age span served by our programs provides the framework from which teachers prepare the learning environment and plan appropriate experiences.

Individual Appropriateness
Each child is a unique person with an individual pattern and timing of growth, as well as an individual personality, learning style, and family background. Both the curriculum and adults' interactions with the children should be responsive to those individual differences. Learning in young children is the result of interaction between the child's thoughts and experiences with materials, ideas, and people.

Themes
Each week we focus on one general theme or concept (camping, the zoo, etc.). The group activities are themed as well. Individual educators are encouraged to base their classroom's appearance and activities on the theme.

Objectives
Each service has its own goals and objectives, appropriate to the age group. The goal is for each child to reach his or her full potential, relative to the time they spend with us. Activities are designed to facilitate learning objectives. While participating in the activities, each child's individual discoveries and progress are noted in that child's file. Every time a similar activity is done or a comparable objective is desired, this record provides the means by which the child's overall progress may be assessed against common core standards, where appropriate.

Some goals and objectives will be determined by the curriculum designer. Others may be determined as appropriate by the educator in each particular service. The Curriculum Development Guide provides more detail about these objectives.

Lesson Plans
Lesson plans can be created by the Approved Provider, Educational Leader, Coordinator or other staff. Lesson plans should be completed the week prior to implementation. A lesson plan dictates the week's events at a glance. A lesson plan should cover every subject area. Each area should have a new item added every week to teach the service's objective(s).

Please refer to the Curriculum Development Guide for more information about how to create lesson plans and develop a curriculum for your classroom.

Other Activities

Outside Play
The play yard is meant to be an extension of our classroom. The items that are in the OSHC room are items that can be adapted for outside use. For instance: the easel. Typically, an easel is set up in the classroom, but outside it becomes different experience for the children. The same goes for the discovery table, dress up, dramatic play, blocks, science, etc. Outside we also play games and, best of all, we get to do lots of things that are unacceptable inside, like yelling and running.

Gross Motor Play
Gross motor play develops and builds large motor skills (walking, crawling, running, jumping, climbing, etc.). Children develop these skills outside while using the play equipment, running, taking walks, and inside by exercising, climbing on the soft blocks, and climbing in the ball pit. These skills are important in many ways. The children develop large muscle movements that ultimately translate into beginning writing skills. Children grow from the trunk of their bodies out to their fingers. They need to master large movements before they can master the small ones. Educators can facilitate play by planning games and exercises.

Small Group Activities
Educators take groups of 2-3 children to work on projects or do assessments. The children get more individual attention in the small group.

Large Group Activities
In large group activities the entire class participates in an activity. This allows the children to use peer interaction to help one another with ideas. This is a great way to teach and use cooperation skills. Older children who have mastered skills are usually willing to help the younger ones. This helps to teach both of the children.

Sharing Time
Sharing time is a large group activity. During sharing time, children learn about the interactions and issues of other children and are often inspired by the experiences of others.

DISCIPLINE
Elysium OSHC is committed to providing a safe, happy, and nurturing environment for the children in our care. Our goal is to help each child grow to his or her potential, and participate in our community at the Service and, ultimately, in the community overall. As with any community, large or small, rules are necessary to ensure smooth functioning and to reduce conflict. With children, it can be difficult to enforce these rules without appropriate strategies of behaviour management to create a sense of discipline. Before we continue, two terms need to be specifically defined to understand out approach to behaviour management:

Discipline: the ongoing process of helping children to develop self-control for self-management while protecting and maintaining the integrity of the child.

Punishment: the use of negative consequences to correct unacceptable behaviour.

Each child potentially presents a unique behavioural challenge, and thus we deal with each situation and circumstance individually. The techniques we use are designed to help the child take responsibility for his or her actions by teaching appropriate behaviours and, when the child acts inappropriately, using positive redirection and reinforcement. Harsh, humiliating, and shaming techniques are counter-productive in most cases, and are thus not used. Time out and other isolation strategies are rarely used.

Positive Discipline Strategies
In circumstances where discipline is necessary, positive techniques of guidance should be used, including redirection, encouragement, and positive reinforcement, rather than competition, comparison, and criticism. Age-appropriate expectations and guidelines should be used to minimize the need for discipline.

1. Develop appropriate limits that protect children's health and safety, teach self-control, and are meaningful. Limits should be stated firmly, positively, and with respect. Some teachers have basic rule: You may not hurt yourself, others, or things.

2. Be clear about rules. Consistent and fair rules help children control their own behaviour. Rules should be kept simple, few in number, truly necessary, and reasonable for the age of the child. Reasons for the rules and limits should be given. Communicate your expectations clearly.

3. Ignore minor misbehaviour. Some children misbehave because they are seeking attention. Find out why a misbehaving child is seeking attention. Encourage the child to voice feelings. Encourage a more acceptable behaviour. This strategy takes time before results are felt, but the result is well worth the effort and time.

4. Distract or redirect children from potential problems. Be ready to step in to shift a child's attention or add a new activity to divert a problem before it gets out of control. Change something about the problem situation. If a child is yelling, whisper something in his/her ear. If two children are fighting over a toy, offer another type. Ask the children to talk over issues and come up with a resolution to their conflict.

5. Use suggestions phrased as a request or question whenever possible. Get the child to actively consider alternatives to the behaviour. "Instead of hitting your friend when she takes your shovel, what could you do?"

6. Use "no choice" statements when you expect a child to do something. "When you clean up your area, we will be ready to go outside."

7. Make "I" statements to children which focuses on the behaviour and consequences, leaving out blame.
 Describe the behaviour. "When you walked off by yourself…"
 State your concerns about the consequence the behaviour produced in you. "I was so worried that something happened to you because I did not know where you were."

8. Deliver logical consequences. Give the child a choice, then accept the choice and communicate your acceptance. An example: While on the playground, a child takes off his shoes and gets up to play. You can say, "You can either put your shoes on and play with your friends, or you may sit here so you won't hurt your feet." If the child chooses to sit, then say, "I see you want to sit. Please make sure you don't get up without your shoes on."

9. Remove the child from the group only when necessary. When a child continues to make unwise choices and refuses to follow directions after all other guidance techniques have been attempted, ask child to choose a quiet toy and play at the table. The child may also choose to go to the "quiet area" to regain control. Explain to the child that when he/she has gained self-control, he/she may return to the group. Allow the child to decide when he/she is ready to return to play. When a child asks to return to play, ask 3 questions:
 "Do you know why I asked you to take a break?"
 "What were you doing?" ("Throwing blocks.")
 "What are you going to do now?" ("Build with the blocks.")
When the child answers the questions, say to the child, "I see that you understand why you were taking a break and that you know what you should be doing. I am going to trust that you will play appropriately now."

10. Remove the child from the environment only when necessary. When a child is hurting him- or herself, others, or things and cannot be redirected, call the Coordinator or Approved Provider for additional help and intervention. The administrator will decide if the child needs to be removed from the room for a short period.

11. Sending the child home for inappropriate behaviour or releasing the child from the Service. Only the Approved Provider can make the decision to send a child home or release the child from the Service.

Some additional important tips:

 Supervision is your best preventive technique. Be aware of all children and what they are doing.

 The Educator sets the example for appropriate play. Remember children look at you as a role model. You should be interacting with the children in a positive manner, discussing their play and actually playing with them.

 Children who are engaged in developmental activities and receive positive reinforcements seldom need redirection. If you are having extreme behaviours, examine the OSHC room, your activities and your guidance techniques.

 Remember children respond much better if their feelings are respected and addressed.

And so we welcome you to the Elysium OSHC family! There's still plenty more to learn and plenty more to do, but our Coordinators, Educators and Approved Provider are ready to help answer your questions and help you contribute your talents and experiences to our Service and the families we serve.

We have many other resources for your use at the Service, and we will introduce you to those as we work together to help ourselves, and the children under our care, grow.

IV. APPENDIX